

Module 5: Climate Change and Migration

Service Learning Project

Climate Resilience Outreach with a Frontline Community Organization

Overview

Work with an environmental justice or emergency-preparedness organization serving immigrant communities to co-create climate-displacement education or resilience resources.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Describe climate migration to a public audience (UG 1)
- Identify causes of climate displacement (UG 2)
- Explain legal gaps in plain language (UG 3)
- Recognize global-to-local impact (UG 4)

Suggested community partners

- Environmental justice coalitions in immigrant neighborhoods
- County emergency management outreach programs
- Community gardens or food-security groups serving newcomers
- Faith or civic groups running disaster-preparedness workshops

Project steps

1. Learn the partner's community context: which climate risks (heat, flood, storm) touch the neighborhoods they serve.
2. Research the connection between global climate displacement and the local community's own migration stories and current risks.
3. Co-design a resource with the partner: multilingual fact sheet, workshop segment, or preparedness guide.
4. Address the legal-gap question honestly: what protection exists (and doesn't) for people displaced by climate.
5. Deliver or present the resource at a partner event.
6. Write a reflection connecting module frameworks (slow vs. rapid onset, environmental justice) to what you observed locally.

Deliverables

- Co-created community resource (partner keeps)
- Presentation or workshop participation
- 2–3 page reflection

Time commitment

14–16 hours.

Ethics requirements

Avoid alarmism; materials are reviewed by the partner before community use.

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Scientific and legal accuracy 30%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: scientific and legal accuracy is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: scientific and legal accuracy is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: scientific and legal accuracy is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: scientific and legal accuracy is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
Genuine co-design with the partner, not for them 25%	Collaboration is genuinely shared: genuine co-design with the partner, not for them is fully realized — partner and community voices shaped key decisions, their priorities are visible in the result, and their contribution is credited.	Collaboration is real: genuine co-design with the partner, not for them is achieved — the partner reviewed and influenced the work, though some decisions stayed one-sided.	Collaboration is thin: genuine co-design with the partner, not for them is claimed more than practiced; the partner was consulted late or superficially, and the result reflects the student's assumptions.	Collaboration is absent: genuine co-design with the partner, not for them did not occur; the work was done about or for the community rather than with it.
Accessibility of the final resource 25%	The deliverable is excellent: accessibility of the final resource is met at a standard the partner or audience can use immediately — complete, accurate, well-organized, and genuinely useful.	The deliverable is good: accessibility of the final resource is met; it is usable with minor revisions and its purpose is clearly served.	The deliverable is incomplete: accessibility of the final resource is only partly met — gaps, errors, or unclear organization mean substantial revision is needed before it could be used.	The deliverable is inadequate: accessibility of the final resource is not met; the product is unusable, inaccurate, or missing major required elements.
Reflection quality 20%	Reflection is genuinely self-examining: reflection quality shows specific assumptions confronted with evidence, real change or evidenced confirmation, and questions that extend beyond the assignment.	Reflection is substantive: reflection quality shows honest engagement with the student's own thinking, supported by course material, with occasional generality.	Reflection is surface-level: reflection quality is attempted but stays safe or generic — conclusions asserted rather than examined, little connection to evidence.	Reflection is performative or missing: reflection quality shows no genuine self-examination or contradicts the evidence presented.